

Q I feel permanently exhausted. What can I eat to give me more energy?

If this is your first or third trimester, your body is working extra hard to either form a baby or enable it to grow enough to be ready for labor and the birth. Choose foods that are rich in protein or fiber to give your body the fuel it needs.

The primary energy-giving nutrients you need are iron, complex carbohydrates, and protein. Try mapping your energy needs over a day and eat appropriately to combat the times when you typically have an energy drain. Aim to load up with protein and complex carbs at breakfast and lunchtime to give you slow-burning energy for up to three to four hours at a time, and make dinner the lightest meal, but still nutritious—think healthy salads, for example. Include a healthy midmorning and midafternoon snack, and don't reach for caffeine and sugary foods. Aside from the fact that these aren't good for you, the energy hit they provide will be short-lived, and you'll soon feel more tired and depleted than you did before.

NUTRIENTS YOUR BODY NEEDS FOR SUSTAINED ENERGY

Include foods containing these energy-enhancing nutrients in your meals and snacks so that you can deal with your day. Eat little and often to stave off hunger pangs and maintain energy levels.

NUTRIENT	ENERGY EFFECTS	FOOD SOURCES
Iron	Improves the health of cells so that oxygen reaches all the body systems efficiently.	Leafy green vegetables (spinach, kale etc.); shellfish; lean meat; dried fruit; nuts and seeds; legumes; whole grains.
Complex carbohydrates	These foods release energy at a steady pace into your body in the short and medium term, preventing the energy spikes that refined carbs (simple carbohydrates) and sugary foods cause.	Whole grains (including brown pasta and rice); oats; fresh fruit and vegetables (particularly starchy vegetables, such as potatoes, corn, green peas, and parsnips); legumes (including beans, peas, and lentils).
Protein	The process of breaking down protein into energy is a long one—first your body separates the protein into its constituent amino acids, which it then converts into glucose (your body's fuel). This means that protein gives you a slow energy release over several hours.	Lean meat; fish; dried legumes (such as beans, peas, and lentils); nuts and seeds; eggs; milk; and yogurt.

Q I often feel thirsty. Is this normal? Can I drink what I want?

It's very normal to find yourself drinking more while pregnant, because your body requires extra fluids to deal with the demands of your growing baby. Your body needs water to flush out toxins and waste—both your own and those generated by your developing baby—from your body. You also need water to produce the extra healthy blood cells needed during pregnancy. These blood cells carry essential nutrients to your baby through the placenta. Staying

well-hydrated during pregnancy is also essential for helping to prevent water retention (edema), dry, itchy skin, fatigue, constipation, urinary-tract infections, and complications in pregnancy associated with dehydration.

Unless your body requires more, or it's a hot day or you live in a warm climate, around 2.3 quarts (2.2 liters) of fluid a day should be sufficient (this is the recommended amount for a healthy adult). If you feel thirsty—or even hungry—you're probably slightly dehydrated.

Stay hydrated Drink at least 8 glasses of fluid a day—water and milk both provide effective hydration.



An app is a great way to check if you are eating enough calories a day by **monitoring your calorie intake** if you want to stabilize your weight. There are lots of free food-journal apps available to help you log your food and beverage intake. Aim for **2,200 calories** a day in the first trimester and **2,300 calories** a day during the second and third trimesters.

